

*1. (50%) Sider and Thomson agree on two claims about the case of the clay statue that will be squashed. (i) The statue is not the same thing as the lump of clay. (ii) At times before the squashing, the statue is part of the lump of clay, and the lump of clay is part of the statue. Given that they agree on this much, is there any sense in which a proponent of the doctrine of temporal parts, like Sider, has a better or more satisfying response to the paradoxes than someone like Thomson who denies that there are temporal parts? Explain.*

To answer this question it was not enough just to discuss Sider's and Thomson's solutions to the paradox, or their views in general; you had to explicitly take a stand on whether one solution was superior or not and give reasons why. Some people discussed topics like the problem of temporary intrinsics in their answers, but this topic is strictly irrelevant to the question.

*2. (50%) According to Thomson, the doctrine of temporal parts is a 'crazy metaphysic--obviously false.' Is she right? Defend your answer.*

Like the problem of temporary intrinsics, the dispute between presentism and eternalism is strictly irrelevant to this question. A lot of people thought this question asked whether or not Thomson's particular objections to the doctrine of temporal parts were good ones. But while discussing Thomson's objections is one way to go about answering the question, it is not the only one. You might think that the doctrine of temporal parts is obviously false for other reasons, reasons Thomson didn't think of.